

Keiko Sukamto

Life Community School - BEAC03

Female Famous Speech - 928

International Women's Day - Michelle Obama

We felt that first flare of outrage when we realized that 62 million girls worldwide — girls who are just as smart and hard-working as we are -aren't getting the opportunities that we sometimes take for granted.

For me, it was the drumbeat of horrifying stories: Malala Yousafzai, shot in the head by terrorists just for speaking the simple truth that girls should go to school. More than 200 Nigerian girls kidnapped from their school dormitory by a terrorist group determined to keep them from getting an education — grown men trying to snuff out the aspirations of young girls. Little girls being brutally assaulted on their way to school, being forced to marry and bear children when they're barely even teenagers. Girls in every corner of the globe facing grave danger simply because they were full and equal human beings -- that's what they decided -- worthy of developing their boundless potential.

And the more I traveled and met with girls and learned from experts about this issue, the more I realized that the barriers to girls' education isn't just resources. It's not just about access to scholarships or transportation or school bathrooms. It's also about attitudes and beliefs — the belief that girls simply aren't worthy of an education; that women should have no role outside the home; that their bodies aren't their own, their minds don't really matter, and their voices simply shouldn't be heard.

And like many of you, as a woman, I take all of this personally. While I'm thankful that I've never faced anything like the horrors that many of these girls endure, like most women, I know how it feels to be overlooked, to be underestimated, to have someone only half listen to your ideas at a meeting -- to see them turn to the man next to you, the man you supervise, and assume he's in charge -- or to experience those whistles and taunts as you walk down the street.

And I've seen how these issues play out not just on a personal level, but on a national level in our laws and policies. You see, in my lifetime, it was perfectly legal for employers to discriminate against women. In my lifetime, women were not legally allowed to make fundamental decisions about their bodies — and practically speaking, many still can't. In my lifetime, domestic violence was seen as a private matter between a man and his wife rather than as the horrific crime that it is.

These issues aren't settled. These freedoms that we take for granted aren't guaranteed in stone. No, these rights were secured through long, hard battles waged by women and men who marched, and protested, and made their voices heard in courtrooms and boardrooms and voting booths and the halls of Congress.

And make no mistake about it, education was central to every last one of those efforts. The ability to read, write, and analyze; the confidence to stand up and demand justice and equality; the qualifications and connections to get your foot in that door and take your seat at that table -- all of that starts with education. And trust me, girls around the world, they understand this. They feel it in their bones, and they will do whatever it takes to get that education.

I've seen it time and time again – girls in Senegal studying at rickety desks in bare concrete classrooms raising their hands so hard they're almost falling out of their chairs. Girls in Cambodia who wake up hours before dawn, ride their bikes for miles just to get to school. Bangladeshi immigrant girls in the United Kingdom who study for hours every night and proudly wear their head scarves everywhere they go, resolutely ignoring those who would demean their religion.

These girls risk everything - the rejection of their communities, the violation of their bodies - everything, just to go to school each day. These girls don't blink. They stand up. They look straight into those cameras and they proudly explain who they want to be – doctors and teachers, forces for change in their countries.

You see, they know that education is their only path to self-sufficiency. It is their only chance to shape their own fate rather than having the limits of their lives dictated to them by others. And I'm passionate about this because I truly see myself in these girls - in their hunger, in their burning

determination to rise above their circumstances and reach for something more. And I know that many of you do, too.

FAMOUS SPEECH REPORT

☐ OPEN

☒ U/16

(Please ✓ the appropriate box)

Name:	Keiko Sukanto	D.O.B.	24/03/12
School:	Life Community School	Cust Code:	BEAC03
Title of Entry:	International Women's Day		

Original Speaker's Background and Traits: (childhood, family, career, religious influence/s, personality, etc.)
Michelle Obama was born on January 17, 1964 in Chicago, Illinois. She grew up in a simple family with her parents and older brother. They valued education hard work, and respect for others. Although they did not have great wealth, her parents encouraged her to do her best and raised her with Christian values and influences. Michelle Obama studied at Princeton University and earned a law degree from Harvard University. From 2009 to 2017, she was the First Lady of the United States during the presidency of her husband, Barack Obama. She became known for promoting education, healthy living, and kindness towards others. Michelle Obama is hardworking, compassionate, and confident, yet humble. Her life shows how hard work and showing compassion can make a positive impact in the world.
Details of the Original Speech: (date, occasion, audience, actual length, etc.)
Michelle Obama delivered this speech on March 8, 2016, during an International Women's Day event celebrating the first anniversary of the Let Girls Learn initiative. She spoke to students, educators, and supporters of girl's education, encouraging the world to remove barriers that prevents girls from attending school. The speech lasted for 19 minutes and 18 seconds. It focused on the belief that every girl deserves the chance to learn and contribute to this world.

(Add additional sheets if necessary)

	7/8/2026
Student's Signature:	Date:

